

Case Study: Senior Product Management – Perimeter Security Appliances (9000 Series)

Objective

This case is designed to evaluate your ability to:

- Understand the perimeter security appliance market and customer requirements
- Analyze competitive positioning — both technical and commercial
- Identify a differentiated feature opportunity and build the business case for it
- Translate the same strategic story into two different audiences, languages, and formats

You will prepare and deliver **two presentations** (session details below), followed by discussion.

Background

Check Point's **9000 series** is our perimeter security gateway appliance lineup, deployed at the network edge, campus, and headquarters — to enforce threat prevention, access control, and segmentation for inbound/outbound traffic.

The perimeter appliance market is mature and highly contested. Customers evaluating a refresh routinely compare us against:

- Fortinet – FortiGate series
- Palo Alto Networks – PA-Series
- Cisco – Secure Firewall (Firepower)

The goal is to **strengthen our competitive position and win-rate** against the above vendors over the next 12–18 months.

Use publicly available data sheets, analyst reports (e.g., Gartner, NSS Labs equivalents), and your own market knowledge to ground your analysis — note any assumptions clearly.

Your Task

1. Perimeter Security Market Overview

Briefly describe:

- How perimeter security fits into a modern network architecture (campus, HQ edge, hybrid/cloud connectivity)
 - Key **buyer requirements**: throughput/latency under full threat prevention, security efficacy, high availability, interface density, manageability/automation, and total cost of ownership
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2. Competitive Analysis — SWOT (Technical & Commercial)

Build a **SWOT analysis** for Check Point 9000 series vs. 2–3 main competitors covering **both** dimensions:

- **Technical:** performance/throughput per RU, acceleration architecture, threat prevention efficacy and latency impact, HA/clustering, interface density and connectivity options, management and automation
- **Commercial:** list pricing and typical discounting, licensing model, TCO across the refresh cycle, channel/partner economics, support and services

Present your findings as a clear Strengths / Weaknesses / Opportunities / Threats summary, and highlight the differentiation opportunities it reveals.

3. New Feature Proposal (Core Section)

Propose **one new feature or capability** for the 9000 series that would give Check Point a clear, defensible advantage over the competitors identified above.

For your proposed feature, include:

- What the idea is
 - Why it matters — what competitive gap it closes
 - Customer value
 - Technical feasibility and hardware/software implications
 - Expected business impact (win-rate, ASP, retention)
 - Key risks / challenges
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4. Session 1 — Internal Executive Briefing (Hebrew)

Audience: R&D, Product, Sales, and Marketing executives

Language: Hebrew

Duration: ~15 minutes, followed by discussion

Your presentation must include:

- The competitive SWOT analysis, and why the 9000 series needs to act now
 - The proposed new feature and its technical rationale
 - The **business case**: investment required vs. expected revenue/win-rate impact, and why this is crucial to have
 - A clear ask — the roadmap or budget decision you want from the executives in the room
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5. Session 2 — Customer-Facing Presentation (English)

Audience: a new enterprise prospect evaluating perimeter gateway vendors

Language: English

Duration: ~15 minutes, followed by discussion

Your presentation must include:

- An overview of the 9000 series lineup — positioning, models, and target use-cases

- Key differentiators, including the new proposed feature framed as a customer benefit (not an internal roadmap item)
 - Why Check Point 9000 is the right choice — professional, evidence-based competitive positioning
 - A clear call to action / next steps
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What We're Looking For

- Clear, structured thinking
 - Understanding of the perimeter security market and competitive landscape
 - Ability to identify a genuinely differentiated, technically feasible feature
 - A compelling, well-quantified business case
 - Ability to adapt one core story to two audiences, two languages, and two purposes
 - Executive presence and clear communication in both Hebrew and English
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Format

- One slide deck, or two — your choice — clearly split into the two sessions
- Session 1: ~15-minute presentation in Hebrew + discussion
- Session 2: ~15-minute presentation in English + discussion